
PAPERBOY

FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 25, 2026

Xi Jinping got a B-2 flyover and a state dinner and left Washington without a single published document, while the 10-year Treasury yield climbed to 5.18%, its highest since July 2007.

AI

Oracle files force majeure on its New Mexico Stargate site

WHAT HAPPENED

Oracle has sent a force majeure notice covering Project Jupiter, the 2.45-gigawatt Stargate campus in New Mexico it is building with OpenAI, SoftBank and Blue Owl Capital. The trigger is power, not silicon: an Energy Transfer natural-gas pipeline has slipped roughly six months to a 1 February 2027 target after repeated permit rejections, and an air-quality permit for the site's Bloom Energy fuel cells faces a 23 November deadline from New Mexico's environment department. The notice would let Oracle delay payments if the campus misses its 2028 target. Oracle says [“Project Jupiter remains on our planned schedule”](#); Blue Owl says “This notice does not change the financial commitments to this multi-year project.” Bloomberg had it first; there is no SEC filing and no Oracle release.

WHAT IT MEANS

The binding constraint on the AI buildout has moved from chips to gas pipelines and air permits. A force majeure notice is a hedge, not an abandonment, but it is the first written admission that Stargate's timetable sits with a state regulator and a pipeline crew.

WATCH NEXT

The Bloom Energy air-quality decision, due 23 November.

White House asks OpenAI and Anthropic to route new models past US reviewers first

WHAT HAPPENED

The Office of the National Cyber Director asked OpenAI and Anthropic to hold new frontier models back from Britain's AI Safety Institute until US agencies have reviewed them, [according to Politico](#), [relayed by The Decoder](#). Anthropic is reported to have complied, restricting its newest model to US organisations. The American counterpart body, the Center for AI Standards and Innovation, is thinly staffed with no permanent director. AISI director Henry de Zoete told Parliament the institute still has frontier-model access and had tested OpenAI's newest model before release. Single-origin reporting, and the model names in the secondary write-up do not match names reported elsewhere this week, so we are not printing them.

WHAT IT MEANS

Pre-release safety testing has been one of the few working pieces of transatlantic AI governance. Routing it through an agency with no confirmed director looks less like review than like a queue.

WATCH NEXT

Whether CAISI gets a director, and whether AISI says publicly that it has lost access to a named model.

Sanders and Casar file a bill to ban superintelligence outright

WHAT HAPPENED

Senator Bernie Sanders and Representative Greg Casar introduced the bicameral [Ban Artificial Superintelligence Act](#) on 23 September. It would permanently prohibit developing or using artificial superintelligence, freeze advanced AI development, and create a cabinet-level AI agency to write safety rules before work could resume. Penalties run to forced dissolution for companies and 20 years' imprisonment for individuals. Sanders says current models “can already hack computer systems, create new types of viruses, and build new AI on their own”; Casar says “AI superintelligence could kill countless people.”

WHAT IT MEANS

It has no path to a floor vote and its authors know it. The point is that the maximalist position now has a bill number, a penalty schedule and a named agency — how a letter becomes a bargaining anchor.

WATCH NEXT

Whether any committee schedules a hearing.

Micron kills its 2GB GDDR7, and the semi tape gives a little back

WHAT HAPPENED

Micron has marked both its 28Gbps and 32Gbps 2GB GDDR7 parts end-of-life, leaving the 3GB module as its only GDDR7 offering — [a supply-chain report, not a Micron announcement](#). TrendForce judges an immediate shortage unlikely, since Micron was never Nvidia's primary GDDR7 source (Samsung since the RTX 50 launch in January 2025, SK hynix from April 2026), but losing a third supplier tightens things. VideoCardz puts 3GB GDDR7 at \$60–70 a module against roughly \$20 for 2GB — about triple the price for half again the capacity. The [PHLX Semiconductor index](#) closed Thursday at 12,492.54, down 41.74 or 0.33%.

WHAT IT MEANS

Memory makers are walking away from the cheap end because HBM and AI-server DRAM pay better per wafer. Graphics cards get the bill, and the bill is the sort that shows up in retail pricing two quarters later.

WATCH NEXT

Micron's fiscal Q1 results on 30 September — memory pricing and the unasked-about German injunctions in one call.

The summit produced no export-control paper at all

WHAT HAPPENED

Thursday's Washington summit generated no chip-trade document of any kind. Checked and empty: [whitehouse.gov presidential actions](#) has nothing after 18 September; the briefings page carries only First Lady and state-dinner logistics for the 24th; Treasury's press releases have nothing on China since 22 September; USTR's most recent item concerns sugar tariff-rate quotas. No joint statement, readout, fact sheet, executive order or Federal Register notice exists on any reachable US government site. The sole on-record extension of the Busan Agreement from 10 November to 10 January remains Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent's televised remark of 23 September. Nothing on rare earths, entity listings or export rules.

WHAT IT MEANS

For the chip trade this was a non-event dressed as a summit. Anyone pricing in a rare-earth's understanding or an easing of export controls is pricing in a sentence spoken on a talk show.

WATCH NEXT

Any USTR or Commerce document, and the first Graham Act designation list.

On the TrendForce wire: 2027 wafer prices and Intel's EMIB yields

WHAT HAPPENED

Three items appeared on [TrendForce's wire](#) on 24–25 September that we are flagging rather than reporting, because we have the headlines and not the bodies: twelve-inch wafer price rises loom for 2027 as AI demand tightens supply, with long-term agreements reportedly up 15–40% or more; CXMT and YMTC are ramping memory capacity that China's own AI and cloud boom could absorb through 2027; and Intel's EMIB substrate yields have reportedly reached 45%, with suppliers eyeing 60% by the first quarter of 2027.

WHAT IT MEANS

If the wafer number holds, it is the first sign that AI demand is repricing the foundry input itself rather than just the finished accelerator. The Intel figure matters because EMIB yield is the gate on how much advanced packaging Intel can actually sell.

WATCH NEXT

TrendForce's full notes, and any foundry confirming 2027 pricing on an earnings call.

BUSINESS

The 10-year hits 5.18%, its highest since July 2007

WHAT HAPPENED

[Treasury par yields](#) rose for a second straight day on Thursday: the 10-year to 5.18% from 5.11%, the 20-year to 5.53% from 5.45%, the 30-year to 5.47% from 5.40%, the 2-year to 4.87% from 4.85%. The 10-year is the highest daily par yield since 6 July 2007, when it printed 5.19%; the last prior day at or above 5.11% was 13 July 2007. Equities went nowhere: the S&P 500 closed 7,704.13, down 1.90; the Nasdaq Composite 26,939.37, up 3.34; the Dow 51,349.98, down 161.61; the Russell 2000 2,835.57, down 3.09.

WHAT IT MEANS

The long end is doing all the work and the 20-year is leading it. That shape is a term-premium move — investors demanding more to hold duration — rather than a repricing of the Fed's next meeting. It is also the more expensive kind, because it lifts mortgage and corporate borrowing costs without any policy decision behind it.

WATCH NEXT

August PCE, Friday 26 September.

Jobless claims fall to 197,000

WHAT HAPPENED

Initial claims for the week ended 19 September came in at **197,000**, down 1,000 from a revised 198,000 and below the roughly 204,000 economists expected. The four-week moving average fell 1,750 to 202,250. Continuing claims for the week ended 12 September were 1,719,000, up 2,000, with the insured unemployment rate unchanged at 1.1%. Every figure is from the Labor Department's own weekly release.

WHAT IT MEANS

There is no softening labour market to offset Tuesday's four-year-high input-cost print. Firms hiring while costs rise is exactly the combination that keeps December live and long yields climbing, and it removes the Fed's usual excuse for looking through an inflation surprise.

WATCH NEXT

The first Fed speaker willing to call December live.

Brent adds another 3.4%

WHAT HAPPENED

Front-month Brent closed Thursday at **\$106.60**, up **3.41%**, after closing Wednesday at \$103.08, up 3.86% — two consecutive sessions of roughly four per cent. These are closes on a continuous front-month series rather than ICE official settlements, and we could not reach a second source, so treat the precision with care. Prices came off session highs intraday on the report of phased US-Iran talks over Hormuz.

WHAT IT MEANS

Oil is now the transmission line between the Gulf and the Fed. S&P Global named fuel and transport as the driver of Tuesday's input-cost jump, which means every dollar on Brent lands in a PMI print three weeks later and in a CPI print six weeks after that.

WATCH NEXT

Whether a second round of indirect talks gets a date.

ElevenLabs reportedly valued at \$22bn — in a tender, not a raise

WHAT HAPPENED

The AI voice company is [reportedly valued at \\$22bn](#) in a tender offer, roughly double the \$11bn it reached in February's \$500m Sequoia-led round. TechCrunch sources the figure to Bloomberg and is explicit that it is unconfirmed and not a primary round — existing shares changing hands. The company says it is pacing at \$600m in annualised revenue, with more than 55% from enterprise: “Fifty-five percent plus is classic enterprise,” chief executive Mati Staniszewski said, naming Klarna, Deutsche Telekom, Cisco and Adobe as customers. On a 2028 listing he offered only that the company is “preparing the foundation to be able to do it in the next years.”

WHAT IT MEANS

A doubling in seven months on a secondary is a liquidity event for employees and early investors, not a fresh capital base. Several outlets are writing it up as a raise; it isn't one, and the distinction matters when judging how much dry powder the company actually has.

WATCH NEXT

A primary round, which would put a real mark on the \$22bn.

Databricks buys Row Zero, its fifth acquisition of the year

WHAT HAPPENED

Databricks [acquired Seattle spreadsheet startup Row Zero](#) on Thursday, terms undisclosed, folding it into Genie, its AI analyst agent, to put a governed spreadsheet surface over live enterprise data. Row Zero, founded by former AWS and Tableau engineers and led by Breck Fresen, raised \$10m in May 2025 and handles billions of rows at interactive speed. It is Databricks' fifth acquisition of 2026, after Quotient AI and SiftD.ai in March, Panther in June and Electric in August. The company closed a \$5bn round in August and says it runs at a \$7bn annualised revenue rate. Chief executive Ali Ghodsi: “We intend to do many more acquisitions like this in the future.”

WHAT IT MEANS

Five tuck-ins in nine months is a company buying its way to feature parity before an IPO window it cannot control. The spreadsheet is the interface enterprise analysts refuse to give up, so owning it is cheaper than arguing with it.

WATCH NEXT

Acquisition six, and any concrete IPO signal.

Ando launches with \$20m to make agents members of the chat

WHAT HAPPENED

Sara Du, the Alloy Automation co-founder and Thiel Fellow, launched [Ando](#) on Thursday with a \$20m seed from Accel, Index Ventures and Emergence Capital, with Contrary Capital also backing. It is a team messaging platform where AI agents are first-class members with persistent identity, permissions and shared context rather than bots bolted on, and it is agent-agnostic across Codex, Claude and Grok. “Starting from scratch, unencumbered by legacy scaffolding, lets us design around what agents are actually capable of,” Du said. Deployment claims — a dozen countries, internal-only use since January — are the company's own.

WHAT IT MEANS

Slack is the target and Slack knows it. The bet is that permissions and memory for agents are architectural rather than bolt-on, which is the only kind of bet a seed-stage company can win against an incumbent.

WATCH NEXT

Whether Slack ships first-class agent identity.

US

Xi gets the flyover, Washington gets no paper

WHAT HAPPENED

Xi Jinping's first White House visit since 2015 ran the full programme on Thursday: a South Lawn ceremony with a B-2 flyover, four F-22s and a silent drill team, an Oval Office bilateral, and a black-tie state dinner whose guests included Jensen Huang, Sam Altman, Elon Musk and Jeff Bezos. Asked what came of it, Trump said [“Great meeting, thank you.”](#) Nothing has been published since. Per Xinhua, Xi urged Trump to oppose Taiwanese independence and handle the issue “prudently” and said he supported the US and Iran returning to an interim agreement — a Chinese state-media characterisation, not independently confirmed. Xi also offered 100,000 American student visits over five years, and two pandas.

WHAT IT MEANS

The only documented change to the relationship remains Bessent's sentence on television. Senators split along the obvious line: Roger Wicker said he would have advised against so lavish a welcome, Rand Paul said “Talk more, war less.” A summit that yields a panda and no text is about atmosphere, which is not nothing — but it is not a trade policy.

WATCH NEXT

Whether any Treasury, USTR or Commerce document materialises this week.

Senate rejects the Iran war-powers resolution by one vote

WHAT HAPPENED

The Senate rejected H. Con. Res. 89, directing the President to remove US armed forces from hostilities with Iran, on [roll call 244](#) at 1:45pm Thursday: 49 yeas, 50 nays, one not voting. Four Republicans crossed — Collins, Murkowski, Paul and Tillis — and one Democrat, Fetterman, voted no; Alsobrooks did not vote. Earlier the same day the chamber agreed to cloture on S. 4668, the student-athlete compensation bill, 74-25. No roll call has been recorded for Friday.

WHAT IT MEANS

A concurrent resolution would not have bound the President even if it had passed, so its function is the record it creates — and the record now shows the Senate one vote short of a majority against the war, with Alsobrooks absent. That is a different number from the one the administration had in August.

WATCH NEXT

Whether sponsors force a second vote with full attendance.

A Trump-appointed judge orders press credentials restored, and is ignored

WHAT HAPPENED

US District Judge Timothy Kelly, appointed by Trump in 2017, issued a 14-day temporary restraining order on Thursday requiring the White House to restore press credentials to [CNN](#), [MS NOW](#) and [Politico](#), revoked the previous Friday first over “fake news” and later on national-security grounds. Kelly found them likely to succeed on a First Amendment viewpoint-discrimination claim — “This is a high bar, but Plaintiffs have met it” — called the standard for objectionable reporting too vague, and rejected the security rationale. Hours later reporters from all three outlets said they were still blocked, and the outlets asked for a further hearing.

WHAT IT MEANS

The ruling is unremarkable as First Amendment law; the interesting fact is the gap between the order and Thursday night's door policy. Non-compliance with a TRO is the step that turns a press-access dispute into a contempt question.

WATCH NEXT

The further hearing, and whether Kelly is asked to find contempt.

Netanyahu addresses a hall that emptied as he arrived

WHAT HAPPENED

Dozens of delegations, mostly Arab and Muslim states, walked out of the General Assembly on Thursday as Benjamin Netanyahu was announced; the Palestinian mission had messaged members urging a coordinated exit, and the UAE stayed. He opened, [per Fox News](#): “Before I begin, just a quick announcement, if there are any other moral cowards who haven't yet left this hall, please do so now.” PBS and Al Jazeera render the tail of that sentence slightly differently and no official transcript was reachable. On Iran he said devastating its nuclear facilities “was hard... but for me, it was one of the easiest decisions I've ever made as prime minister”. He called Erdogan a tyrant; Ankara rejected the remarks on Friday as baseless.

WHAT IT MEANS

The walkout is the story rather than the speech. Israel's diplomatic isolation is now performed in the chamber itself, which changes nothing militarily and everything about what a future ceasefire framework can be negotiated through.

WATCH NEXT

Israel's 27 October election.

A phased Hormuz deal is floated, and the squeeze on Iran tightens elsewhere

WHAT HAPPENED

Washington and Tehran are exploring a phased arrangement in which Iran would allow navigation through Hormuz in return for the US lifting its economic blockade, with possible access to frozen assets, [according to a senior Iranian official](#) cited on Thursday. Former negotiator Dennis Ross put the chance of a deal before the 3 November US vote at 30%. President Pezeshkian told Fox News “It's America that must choose whether it wants to end this or not.” Separately, the UAE suspended all Iranian airline flights from 24 September to comply with US sanctions and Colombia cut diplomatic ties with Tehran — both single-source and unconfirmed elsewhere.

WHAT IT MEANS

Anonymous sourcing on both sides, so read it as a trial balloon rather than a negotiation. What is real is the asymmetry it reveals: the US wants the strait, Iran wants the money, and neither is asking about the nuclear programme.

WATCH NEXT

Iran's Permanent Observer Establishment date, 27 September, and whether a second indirect round is scheduled.

A 14-year-old killed in Kyiv as Ukraine claims deeper strikes

WHAT HAPPENED

A Russian drone struck a 16-storey residential block in Kyiv's Pecherskyi district overnight into Friday, between the tenth and eleventh floors, [killing a 14-year-old boy and injuring at least nine](#). Ukraine says it hit a Russian oil refinery some 900 miles from the border and an electronics factory on Friday, after striking oil depots in Rostov Oblast and Krasnodar Krai on Thursday — Ukrainian claims, with no Russian confirmation. Zelensky announced agreement on a new batch of Patriot interceptors; the US allocated \$27m for returning Ukrainian children taken to Russia.

WHAT IT MEANS

Both sides are now aiming at what the other burns. Ukraine's refinery campaign is the only lever it holds on the oil price that is currently financing the war, which makes every successful strike simultaneously good for Kyiv and bad for the Federal Reserve.

WATCH NEXT

Whether Macron's proposed moratorium on energy-infrastructure strikes gets any Russian response.

SOURCES

[Treasury — Daily par yield curve, September 2026](#)

[Labor Department — Unemployment insurance weekly claims, 24 September](#)

[US Senate — Roll call vote 244, H. Con. Res. 89](#)

[Nasdaq — PHLX Semiconductor Index \(SOX\)](#)

[White House — Presidential actions \(nothing after 18 September\)](#)

[UPI — Trump and Xi meet at the White House](#)

[Al Jazeera — Four takeaways from the Washington summit](#)

[Fox News — Mass walkout before Netanyahu's UN address](#)

[PBS NewsHour — Netanyahu addresses the 2026 General Assembly](#)

[CP24 — Judge orders White House to restore press access](#)

[TechCrunch — Oracle sends force majeure notice on New Mexico Stargate](#)

[SiliconANGLE — Oracle force majeure over energy delays](#)

[The Decoder — White House asks OpenAI and Anthropic to delay UK model access](#)

[The Decoder — Bill proposes a permanent ban on artificial superintelligence](#)

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[TechCrunch — Twenty minutes with the CEO of ElevenLabs](#)

[TechCrunch — Databricks buys Row Zero](#)

[TechCrunch — Ando builds team messaging for humans and agents](#)

[Investing.com — Brent crude historical data](#)

[Investing.com — US and Iran discuss a phased Hormuz deal](#)

